

KEY WORDS AND TERMS

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THE TEIRE

The temple administration owns Gherci's grand central temple in the capital of Tarmet. The Teire is the most powerful religious institution in Gherci, effectively making the kingdom a semi-hierocratic state. The institution is led by the Main Master (high priest) who oversees religious law, and his inner circle includes the Lord Protector of the temple and the Supreme Inner Court keeper. The Main Master of The Teire technically outranks the king in matters of faith and can dictate certain policies, giving the priesthood enormous influence over Ghercian governance.

ASATA

Asata is the divine language spoken among the gods. It is primarily a spoken language - divine communication does not require writing - though written fragments exist in pre-War of Gods I artifacts. Asata cannot be learned by mortals without divine ancestry. House Kulio could speak Asata due to their Sky People heritage, though the ability degraded over successive generations. The saint Harnua understood some words but could not speak fluently. By Minara's era, the Kulios have lost the ability entirely and only recognize sacred phrases as prayers without understanding their literal meaning.

THE GATE

A moving hell dimension with no fixed location that can spawn anywhere on the Mystic Isles at any given time. The Gate brings monsters from both the realm of the gods and the dream plane into the mortal world. It is the central mystery of A Crown of Glory - no one in the story knows why it appeared. After the Empress is defeated, the characters believe she caused it. The Gate is connected to the corrupted world doors that Vandrea damaged during A Princess in Love using Merigen's residual magic, now worsened by Renedin's influence as he attempts to

break the barrier between realms entirely. Appears in A Crown of Glory (Book 4).
Cross-reference: LOCATIONS - The Gate.

Gates and world doors are the same structures referred to by different terminology. Mortals call them “gates” while theologians and mages call them “world doors.” They are weak points in the barrier Vapaz raised after the War of Gods I — not created by anyone, but scar tissue from attempting to separate realms that naturally flow into each other. The Mystic Isles were always liminal, a place where the mental and physical realms overlapped even before the barrier existed. When Vapaz raised the barrier, the Isles could not be fully sealed because they were inherently in-between.

Ekhasostio and Paxtino’s birth - twins born of divine grief, one tear becoming two - resonated with these natural weak points, making the doors more navigable and responsive to mortal emotion and intention. Before the twins, the doors were just tears in reality. After the twins, they became something closer to portals, still dangerous but usable by those who approached them correctly.

The legend of Ekhasostio and Paxtino standing guard at the gates is a religious interpretation, not literal truth. The twins do not physically stand there. The idea that “one leads to salvation, one leads to ruin” reflects the actual danger: one door was always more stable while the other was closer to breaking. Vandrea corrupted the unstable door during A Princess in Love, which is why demons leak through unevenly rather than flooding the world all at once.

DALIKA UAER

Dalika Uaer is the first known person to survive a Valoka demon possession. After the encounter, Dalika created a warning drawing documenting the experience, which became the earliest recorded visual description of a Valoka - an eight-foot-tall purple spirit with bug-like wings that attacks through the dream plane.

ETHNIC GROUPS (TAILI, BARIE, NEMERI, GUIO)

The four major ethnic groups of the world - Taili, Barie, Nemer, and Guio - originated from the dispersal of peoples after the Age of Origin, with geography shaping distinct populations over millennia.

Taili settled the southern and central regions, primarily Gherci, adapting to warm climates. Barie populated the western territories of Aicruae and Pireaynea, adapting to cooler climates. Nemeru established themselves in coastal areas and islands, primarily Coelum, developing a maritime culture. Guio settled the eastern mountains, primarily Vikistv.

Current population distributions reflect both ancient settlement patterns and more recent historical events including wars, migrations, and imperial conquest.

DANEPELIE

The Danepelie is the governing council of the Cidet, composed of senior priests representing all twelve gods. No single nation controls the Danepelie — the council guards the Cidet’s sacred neutrality and operates with its own temple guards (volunteers who sever all national allegiances), its own treasury (funded by pilgrim donations), and its own religious law that supersedes secular law within temple grounds. The High Conclave guards the Cidet’s independence jealously. (See also: LOCATIONS doc — Cidet entry for full governance details)

MONSTRU PLAGUE

A plague that killed a lesser lord and his entire family who owned Gavara Castle, located near the Solisian Academy. After the lord’s death, the castle was abandoned and eventually renovated into the Training Grounds used by Academy students and the Special Division. The exact nature, origin, and timeline of the Monstru Plague are not yet detailed - it is unclear whether the plague was magical, natural, or connected to the demon incursions. Referenced in A Crown of Glory (Book 4).

HAITAK

A drug regularly used by Vandrea Asleleri for anger management. Vandrea, the second daughter of City Lord Ceval of Torad, had anger management issues from a young age and took Haitak to manage her temper. The drug’s exact composition, origin, and side effects are not yet detailed. It is mentioned in A Tale of Three Sisters as part of Vandrea’s characterization at the story’s opening - she is described as a hot-head with brashness, and the Haitak was part of how she managed that.

[CONFIRM: Is Haitak a Vikistv-specific substance? Is it made from plants, alchemical compounds, or something else? Does it have side effects or social stigma attached to its use?]

Featured In: A Tale of Three Sisters

THE GREAT TEMPTRESS

A posthumous name given to Apharia Asleleri by the gods and goddesses after the Second War of the Gods. Apharia, the youngest of the three sisters from Torad, fell in love with Soli (the mortal form of the twin gods Paxtino and Ekhasostio) while living in exile in the Nedi Forest of Equateiy. She became pregnant by him, a union that violated the First Divine Law and triggered the Second War of the Gods. As punishment, the god Vapaz killed both Apharia and her daughter.

The gods' choice to name Apharia "The Great Temptress" places the blame on her rather than on Soli - the god who chose to walk among mortals and pursue a relationship with a human woman. This framing reflects the power dynamics between gods and mortals: the mortal woman is blamed for "tempting" a god, while the god is spared (Vapaz did not kill Soli because he was the child of his sister Zopha).

See also: FIRST DIVINE LAW, WAR OF THE GODS II

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THE OATH OF MEMIET - ORIGIN AND PURPOSE

The Oath of Memiet was created by Iswan, Goddess of Alchemy, as a fail-safe when she proposed the Saint system to Vapaz. The Oath functions as a binding contract: gods cannot take from mortals without giving something in return. All divine-mortal transactions must be mutual.

This makes the gods contractually vulnerable to mortals in ways they did not initially anticipate. The Oath is also the reason Javehet magic (god-granted magic) is so rare - the cost of granting it is real for the gods.

The Oath was part of Iswan's long-term plan to reduce mortal dependence on divine whim. By forcing reciprocity, she ensured that gods could not simply

demand worship and sacrifice without consequence.

(See also: MAGIC SYSTEM - Magic's Origin section, which mentions the Oath in the context of Verna's wish)

CODE NAMES (SPECIAL DIVISION)

Every member of the Solisian Academy's Special Division is assigned a code name upon induction. These code names are drawn from the names of the Twelve Saints, linking each soldier's duty to the sacred legacy of those who sacrificed themselves for the world. The code names used by the latest team are: Bura (Minara Gonia), Argellon (Nivaeran Veir), Malign (Dahnyliein Catern), Nairan (Karniode Vesmen), Dorthargel (Isaeri Ashonve), Aliirusk (Elleraian Betenadia Patton), Reron (Vasert Prairn), and Galamma (Silaena Chairameron). Code names serve both operational security during covert missions and a symbolic purpose - members carry the weight of a saint's name as a reminder of what they fight to protect.

ECLIPSING SUN

An imperial title referring to the firstborn child of the reigning Emperor of the Solisian Empire. The term carries both literal and symbolic weight - the firstborn is the "sun" that will one day eclipse the current ruler's reign. In Crown of Glory, the title carries layered irony: Crown Prince Elleraian Betenadia Patton is publicly recognized as the first Eclipsing Sun, but Minara Gonia is the actual firstborn of Emperor Veo Olem Patton. Minara is the true Eclipsing Sun, hidden since birth when Empress Macenja ordered her execution for being female. An ancient Academy prophecy references the title: "When the Eclipsing Sun and the False Star meet, the old god shall shatter the world." Minara is unaware of her connection to this prophecy for most of the story.

VALOKA

A type of demon that operates on the dream plane, luring souls out of their bodies while the victim sleeps. Valokas are among the more insidious demon types because their attacks leave no visible marks and can be mistaken for ordinary sleepwalking or nightmares. Professor Leranoan Gevhilem identifies Valoka activity as the likely cause when Minara Gonia begins sleepwalking dangerously at

the Solisian Academy - on one occasion nearly drowning herself in a lake during a trance state. The Valokas' ability to target victims through dreams suggests a connection to Renedin, the Old God of Dreams, whose domain encompasses the subconscious and the space between realities. Their increased activity during the events of Crown of Glory is part of the broader escalation of demon attacks orchestrated by Empress Macenja/Vandrea in service of Renedin's plan to break the barrier between the divine and mortal realms. Valokas are studied in the Theory of Origin course at the Solisian Academy alongside other demon types including Namilrane, Akotia Jerctika, Zelian, Lim, Vorel, Alem, Jali, and Plova.

THE SPECIAL DIVISION

A highly specialized division within the Solisian Academy established to train soldiers with the skills necessary to combat the constant threat posed by demons and monsters. Members of the Special Division execute covert missions and adhere to orders issued directly by the Council of Seven. Joining the division means the student has demonstrated the potential to protect the Empire from attack, and their commitment must be unwavering. The division operates under a structured role system with assigned code names - each member's code name corresponds to the name of one of the Twelve Saints, reflecting the sacred duty the division carries. The role structure is as follows:

Team Leader - Commands the unit in the field and makes final tactical decisions. The Leader bears ultimate responsibility for mission success and the safety of all members.

Frontline Manager - Coordinates offensive operations and directs the Frontline Defenders during combat. Acts as the Leader's right hand in battle.

Secondline Manager - Coordinates defensive and support operations, directing Secondline Defenders, Healers, and Crafters. Ensures the team's logistics and fallback strategies remain intact.

Frontline Defender — The primary combatants who engage enemies directly. Frontline Defenders are the first to face threats and bear the heaviest physical risk.

Secondline Defender — Supports the Frontline Defenders from a secondary position, providing ranged attacks, barriers, or tactical reinforcement. Can shift to frontline duty if needed.

Healer - Responsible for treating injuries and maintaining the team's physical condition during and after missions. Some Healers double as Secondline Defenders.

Weapon Crafter / Gear Maker - Designs, builds, and maintains the team's weapons, armor, and specialized equipment. Crafters are essential for preparing the team before missions and can rig explosives or engineer battlefield tools.

The latest known team roster: Minara Gonia (Team Leader, Code Name: Bura), Nivaeran Veir (Frontline Manager, Code Name: Argellon), Dahnyliein Catern (Secondline Manager, Code Name: Malign), Karniode Vesmen (Frontline Defender, Code Name: Nairan), Isaeri Ashonve (Frontline Defender, Code Name: Dorthargel), Elleraian Betenadia Patton (Healer/Secondline Defender, Code Name: Aliirusk), Vasert Prairn (Secondline Defender, Code Name: Reron), and Silaena Chairameron (Weapon Crafter/Gear Maker, Code Name: Galamma).

A former team also operated under the division with members known only by their code names: Code Name A (Arolim magic, Frontline Manager), Code Name K2 (Kari magic, Leader), and Code Name K1 (Kari magic, Secondline Manager).

THE WEEKDAYS

The seven-day week in the Solisian Empire is named after the gods of new. Each day carries the name of a deity, reflecting the centrality of divine worship in everyday life. The days are: Vapaz (Monday), Razar (Tuesday), Finore (Wednesday), Nellebrie (Thursday), Nimlye (Friday), Zopha (Saturday), and Allan (Sunday). Allan's day is the customary rest and market day across most of the Empire. At the Solisian Academy, class schedules are organized around these weekday names - for example, Ancient Ananara Language meets on Finore and Nellebrie, while Ethics and Lawful Governing meets on Nimlye and Zopha.

RED TORCH

A danger symbol used by the people of Vikistv. Because fire can kill the people of Vikistv, the lighting of a red torch serves as a warning that something catastrophic

has happened or is happening. The red torch communicates danger specifically because fire is lethal to Vikistv's people - the very element used as the warning signal is itself the threat, making it impossible to ignore.

During Solis's conquest of Vikistv, City Lord Ceval Asleleri - moments before being dragged to his execution - briefly escaped his captors and lit the red torch to warn his people that Vikistv had fallen. He was recaptured and executed immediately after.

See also: VIKISTV, CEVAL ASLELERI

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LIFE AND DEATH MAGIC (Vikistv Classification)

The people of Vikistv believed that magic users can be grouped into two categories: Life and Death.

Life magic encompasses Nature, Healing, and Purity - it is the accepted, respected form of magic practiced openly in Vikistv.

Death magic encompasses Chaos, Destruction, and the Peculiar - it is considered extremely taboo. Practitioners of death magic are viewed with suspicion and fear.

Vandrea Asleleri's first use of death magic occurs in A Tale of Three Sisters when, after hearing an Equateiy townsman insult her family, she unconsciously causes him to choke. She describes feeling "the darkness from deep within her soul" and hears a faint voice telling her to kill him. This is the reader's first account of a character tapping into the death side of magic.

[NOTE: Check MAGIC SYSTEM hub doc to see if this Life/Death classification is already documented there. If so, this KEY WORDS entry should cross-reference rather than duplicate.]

See also: MAGIC SYSTEM, VIKISTV, VANDREA ASLELERI

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KIS

The currency of Vikistv. Vikistv uses gems as currency and their currency is called Kis. Kis is valued at thirty dollars each. See also: RERN (Aicruae), MIUAE (Gherci),

BREZERYIOL (Pireaynea), PEL (Equateiy), OPEALI (Coelum).

Additional festival entries (other festivals besides those already in Key Words - the existing festivals are Allan's Blessing, Sun Solstice, Feast of Plenty, Festival of Vapaz, and Circle of Light Pageant, which are different):

- Day of the Gods - August 17 (Fasteri Adeo 17)
- Festival of Unity - December 21 (Agariso 21)
- Celebration of the Saints - March 24 (Lac 24)
- Remembers Day - January 26 (Yita 26)
- Celebration of The Solis Empire - September 23 (Lacai 23)
- Martyrs' Festival - August 29 (Fasteri Adeo 29)
- Parents Day - November 11 (Niserfa 11)
- Festival of Worship - May 1 (Saer 1)
- Festival of the Sun - June 14 (Ocinyi 14)
- Festival of the Moon - December 30 (Agariso 30)

MOUNT AICREN

The giant mountain upon which Vikitsv sits. Mount Aicren gives Vikitsv the coldest climate in the entire world because of the height of the mountain. Because Vikitsv is located on a long stretch of a mountain, it takes three months to get there on average. Many people have died venturing up the long stretch of the mountain to Vikitsv. The goddess Nellebrie is credited with creating Mount Aicren, and the people of Vikitsv have respect for Nellebrie because of this. See also: VIKITSV, NELLEBRIE.

THE MAGIC TOWER

The ruling institution of Vikitsv, created by the descendants of Verna in 7,749 BR. The Magic Tower is comprised of the best and brightest magic users. The tower is located on the right side of Mount Aicren at a lower standing than the capital city. It was created in such a way because it makes it so whoever wants to enter the city has to go past the tower first. The magic tower is under constant protection and holds roughly four hundred wizards at a time teaching and training them to use their magical abilities. The tower was first under the control of a powerful magician named Ulian and his sons Kiear and Liaerto III but it has passed down from generation to generation of fathers to their sons. The current Grand Sorcerer is the child of Ulian's son Kiear. The most famous architecture in Vikitsv is the statue dedicated to the goddess Iswan standing 60 feet tall and located in the center of the tower. The magic users pray at the statue of Iswan almost twenty times a day to thank her for their gifts. See also: VIKITSV, MOUNT AICREN.

Noirta:

The myth of the first song that founded the world. Noirta is more than a myth—it is the fabric of time and power, teaching that no soul ever truly dies. Souls cycle through existence like droplets in air. Death is but a pause in a very long song, and like all songs, souls have a start and finish—but the best transcend, create, fade, and repeat. Each time we die, our souls stay intact. A good person shall be reborn as a calm infant; a bad person might become a tyrant. Souls are so intricate that even the gods cannot change their fundamental nature.

Noirta is the first song—the fabric of time and power, the endless cycle of souls and energy that makes existence possible. It is not a being, not a creator deity, and not a myth in the conventional sense. It simply is, and always has been, and always will be. No soul ever truly dies; they cycle through Noirta endlessly, carrying experiences from past lives into new bodies. Death is but a pause in a very long song. The four Old Gods (Renedin, Mikani, Poaranji, Haxenylian) crystallized from Noirta as the cosmos's first conscious expressions, but they did not create it and do not fully understand it. There is no one above the Song. The twin prophets Vekta and Aryanara were the first to translate Noirta's cosmic nature into teachings mortals could follow, and their work became the foundation of the Circle of Eternal Light.

Sun Forged/Sunforged

Regular humans not originally descended from the divine. Unlike the People of the Sky or People of the Mountain, they have no divine ancestry.

Regular humans not originally descended from the divine. Unlike the People of the Sky or People of the Mountain, the Sun Forged are entirely mortal people untainted by divine lineage. Created approximately 30,000 + *BR*, the Sun-Forged spread across the world over millennia and laid the foundations of mortal civilizations. By the time of the Saints, humankind had established itself globally, worshipping the gods and subject to the influences of earlier mythic events. The Sun-Forged represent the baseline of humanity - the god-touched Sky and Mountain folk are the exception, not the rule. See also: NOIRTA.

The Land Without Sun

During the Warrior's Age, a powerful sorcerer-jealous of Nimlye's mirrors and angered by the women punished in the Wrath of Fire-bargained with Paha and Finore to conceal the sun. For forty days the sun vanished, seas froze, and crops failed. The resulting famine led to mass migration and the death of a third of the population.

MAIN MASTER

The high priest who leads The Teire, Gherci's powerful temple administration. The Main Master oversees religious law and heads an inner circle that includes the Lord Protector of the temple and the Supreme Inner Court keeper. In Gherci's theocratic system, the Main Master technically outranks the king in matters of faith, making this position one of the most powerful in the kingdom. See also: THE teire.

LORD PROTECTOR OF THE TEMPLE

A senior position within The Teire's inner circle in Gherci, serving directly under the Main Master. The Lord Protector is responsible for the physical and spiritual security of Gherci's grand central temple in Tarmet. See also: THE TEIRE, MAIN MASTER.

WARRIORS' AGE

Dates: 8,900BR – 7,945BR

Duration: Approximately 955 years

Significance: The period when the majority of kingdoms were founded. Called the "Warriors' Age" because of the number of wars that took place during this time.

Kingdoms Founded During This Period:

- Equateiy (8,900 BR) - First kingdom
- Gherci (8,763 BR) - Founded by Saint Duri
- Aicruae (8,759 BR) - Founded by King Haliour Layern Patton I
- Coelum (8,494 BR) - Will later become mostly atheistic
- Vikistv (7,945 BR) - Founded by Grand Mage Verna, ending the Warriors' Age

Note: Most wars were internal disputes to ensure establishment of countries, not wars between nations. Pireaynea (7,400BR) was the only country NOT founded during this time.

SUPREME INNER COURT KEEPER

A senior position within The Teire's inner circle in Gherci, serving directly under the Main Master alongside the Lord Protector of the temple. See also: THE TEIRE, MAIN MASTER.

MIUAE

The currency of Gherci. Valued at roughly \$26 USD each, making it the third most valued currency in the world. The Miuae's strength reflects global trust in Gherci's stable economy and the wealth pouring in from continental trade and temple donations. See also: RERN (Aicruae), BREZERYIOL (Pireaynea), PEL (Equateiy), OPEALI (Coelum).

BREZERYIOL

The currency of Pireaynea. Valued at roughly \$17 USD each, though not widely circulated internationally due to Pireaynea's limited formal trade networks. The

country's weak central authority and lawless reputation meant currency exchange was rare, with much commerce occurring through black markets or smuggling rather than official channels. See also: RERN (Aicruae), MIUAE (Gherci), PEL (Equateiy), OPEALI (Coelum).

OPEALI

The currency of Coelum. Valued at roughly \$5 USD each, making it the lowest valued currency known on the continent. The Opeali was practically useless outside Coelum; many merchants refused it, preferring barter or Equateiy's Pel for any dealings. The currency's worthlessness reflected Coelum's collapsed economy and dependence on foreign creditors. See also: RERN (Aicruae), MIUAE (Gherci), BREZERYIOL (Pireaynea), PEL (Equateiy).

BLOODY WINTER (8,259 BR)

The first successful coup against the royal family of Aicruae, lasting only a few months but claiming over 3,000 lives - including many royal relatives and lesser nobles. Occurred three years after the Battle of Little Hill and Battle of Bears, triggered by extreme wealth inequality: nobles paraded their riches while the poor starved and died - a "let them eat cake" situation. Peasants attacked nobles during winter, kicked them from their homes, and told them to freeze to death. Though the rebels were eventually caught and hanged, the impact was permanent: Bloody Winter shattered the notion that the royal family was untouchable and planted a bitterness in the lower classes that only grew over the centuries, eventually leading to the Siege of Highwater. See also: THE BATTLE OF LITTLE HILL & THE BATTLE OF BEARS, THE SIEGE OF HIGHWATER.

POCORKI

The language spoken in Pireaynea. Presumably a dialect that might be mutually intelligible with Aicruan but distinct enough to be considered a separate tongue. The linguistic difference, combined with Pireaynea's religious divergence (monotheistic Allan worship), contributed to the country's cultural isolation from its neighbors.

LAND OF SAND AND TIME

Poetic nickname for Coelum, referring to the vast stretches of barren or sandy land and the timeless, forlorn quality of its empty horizons. The name evokes both the desertified wasteland geography and the sense that Coelum is “stuck in time”- its people living in semi-medieval simplicity with no grand progress. Fierce winds howl across flat expanses, and the desolate landscape contributes to the spiritual emptiness of a people who have abandoned their gods. See also: COELUM, THE FORSAKEN LAND.

THE FORSAKEN LAND / THE FORSAKEN PLACE

Epithet for Coelum, earned due to both its godlessness and its wasteland geography. After enduring plagues, famines, and abandonment by their ruling class, the people of Coelum lost faith in the gods “who they say abandoned them to die.” The name became a byword for cursed or unlucky-a place where the gods turned their backs. Sometimes used interchangeably with “Land of Sand and Time.” See also: COELUM, LAND OF SAND AND TIME.

LINGIA

The imperial name given to Pireaynea after Aicruae’s empire absorbed it. When the empire formed, Pireaynea was placed under direct control and its longstanding anarchy was subdued by imperial troops. The renaming signified the end of Pireaynea as an independent (if chaotic) state and its integration into the imperial system. See also: PIREAYNEA, THE DEMON’S PIT.

HIKAI

The imperial name given to Coelum after Aicruae’s empire absorbed it. Coelum was easily absorbed as a vassal since it had no strength to resist, its economy collapsed and its population decimated by generations of suffering. The renaming marked the formal end of Coelum’s nominal independence. See also: COELUM, THE FORSAKEN LAND.

YUAVEKIO

Legendary founder of Coelum. According to popular account, Yuavekio was a drunken explorer who accidentally stumbled upon the land that would become

Coelum, implying it was never an obviously fertile or strategic prize. His gambling and spending left an “enormous debt” that bankrupted the nation—a debt Coelum never paid off. To service these debts, Coelum eventually gave away up to 40% of national earnings to Equateiy and Vikitsv. After Yuavekio’s line failed, any nobility lost relevance, and Coelum descended into the impoverished, atheistic state that later generations would know. See also: COELUM, OPEALI.

ANANARA:

- Primary language of Aicruae
- Became standard trade language across empire due to Aicruae’s central political importance
- Written form: Kurti script (imperial standard)

The common language of the Solisian Empire, established as the lingua franca after Solis’s conquest unified all six kingdoms. Before unification, each kingdom maintained its own language and dialects. By the time of the empire’s consolidation, Ananara becomes the standard language of governance, trade, and diplomacy. Solis himself writes in Ananara.

KURTI

written form of Ananara. Imperial standard—even nations with own spoken languages often write in Kurti for official documents

SPEAIL

Language of Gherci and Coelum

TRAER, JAL’VAE, AND DORRENA

Three languages of Vikistv (reflecting convergence of peoples)

Traer: Combines Speail and Pocorki elements

Jal’vae: Blends Speail and Ananara

Dorrena: Merges Kurti with Audru

LATO

Equateiy's language

AUDRU

Equateiy's rural language

Used by common people outside wealthy urban centers

The language divide mirrors Equateiy's class tensions

MERCHANT CLASS:

- Rising class, especially post-Reconstruction or AR
- Accumulated wealth rivaling or exceeding many noble houses
- Economic power hasn't translated to equivalent social standing
- Old nobility looks down on them as "new money"
- Can purchase noble titles (heavily restricted, socially stigmatized)
- Maximum purchasable title: Count equivalent
- Higher ranks (Marquess, Duke, royal) exclusively through birth or direct royal grant
- Purchased titles carry invisible asterisk-old nobility remembers and treats accordingly

PEASANT CLASSES:

- Conditions vary significantly by region
- Agricultural regions (Pireaynea, parts of Aicruae): Many bound to land under serfdom
- Cannot leave without lord's permission
- Owe labor obligations (set days per year on lord's fields)
- Not slaves-cannot be bought/sold individually-but movement/opportunity severely constrained

Diverse economies (Vikistv, Equateiy): Greater freedom

- Free farmers own/rent land, owe only taxes

- Urban workers can change employers

Paths to improve station: Marriage to nobility (possible but heavily frowned upon), military service (promotions, land grants, occasional minor titles), successful merchant venture (rare without starting capital)

SLAVERY:

- Three mechanisms: Debt slavery, conquest slavery, birth slavery
- Debt slavery: Cannot pay obligations, sold to cover debt. Example: Enyokia's sale. Technically serve defined period, in practice many never earn freedom.
- Conquest slavery: Prisoners of war, conquered populations. Diminished in Minara's relatively peaceful era.
- Birth slavery: Children of slaves inherit status. Creates permanent underclass.
- Freedom possible through: Purchase of freedom, manumission by owners, legal decree
- The Undesired: Freed slaves. Technically peasants under law, practically lowest rung. Stigma persists for generations.
- Legal status: Technically illegal throughout empire (no legal "slave" category after Astyan II reforms). However, this is polite fiction—enforcement virtually nonexistent, practice persists under different terminology.

THE FIGHT OF TITIAN

A specific battle during Civil War Year Five (7,217 BR) in which Dame Kisaleli - one of Orcus's most feared warriors - was defeated. The god Razar directly intervened on Solis's behalf by blinding Dame Kisaleli during combat, marking one of the few instances of direct divine intervention in the civil war. Kisaleli's last words were "Glory to Orcus, the one true king." See also: RAZAR (Religion), DAME KISALELI (In Story Characters or Historical Figures, or A TALE OF A THOUSAND SONGS BOOK INFO).

TREATY OF DEOUILU

A treaty broken by Orcus during Civil War Year Three (7,219 BR). [Further details TBD - the specific terms of the treaty and what its breaking triggered need confirmation.] The violation contributed to the escalating loss of international support for Orcus's regime.

FESTIVAL OF MOURNING

A significant royal event during which King Benjamin Lawrence Patton II named his nine-year-old son Solis as heir to the throne, bypassing the legitimate twins Orcus and Iris. The Festival took place approximately four months before the king's sudden death in 7, 241BR. This decision was the direct catalyst for the twins' coup and, ultimately, the Aicruan Civil War. See also: KING BENJAMIN II (Historical Figures).

THE FIGHT OF BLOOD

The name given to the period following Princess Kamerida Mava's assassination by Iris Aleka Patton during Civil War Year Four (7,218 BR). The assassination of Gherci's princess escalated the conflict dramatically, cementing Gherci's alliance with Solis and intensifying the violence of the final campaigns. The era is characterized by particularly brutal warfare and reprisals on both sides.

THE LAND OF ETERNAL SILENCE

Poetic nickname for Gherci, referring to the calm, reverential atmosphere found in the kingdom's temple groves and misty highlands. The name evokes the spiritual tranquility of Gherci's countless pilgrimage sites rather than literal quiet-in reality, Gherci is a bustling kingdom with the continent's largest population. Travelers often note how serene and timeless parts of the landscape feel, particularly the evergreen forests around temples and the mist-shrouded mountain ranges. See also: GHERCI.

THE DEMON'S PIT

Nickname for Pireaynea, earned not from literal geography but from the kingdom's reputation for violent crimes and lawlessness. Due to the founder Deasn's background (fleeing Gherci after treason charges) and the weak central authority

that followed, many consider Pireaynea a sketchy country filled with bandits. The flat, open terrain paradoxically contributed to this reputation-with few natural barriers, trouble could move freely across the land. See also: PIREAYNEA.

KAS

Aicruan term for cheese. A semi-hard farmhouse cheese commonly produced across Aicruae's dairy regions. Along with cured sausages and pickled vegetables, kas forms the basis of simple field laborers' lunches.

HIPPOCRAS

Spiced wine mulled with spices and sweetened with honey or sugar. A favored celebratory drink at Aicruae's tables, often served alongside regular grape wine at festivals and court occasions. See also: STRAWBERRY WINE (served as strawberry-infused hippocras).

Aicruae's HUNTER'S STEW

A nationally renowned dish reflecting Aicruae's forest bounty and winemaking tradition. A slow-cooked medley of venison or rabbit with wild mushrooms, root vegetables, and red wine. Considered quintessentially Aicruan.

ALLAN'S BLESSING

Spring planting festival honoring Allan, goddess of nature. Priests consecrate seeds and villages feast for fertility. One of the major seasonal festivals in Aicruae's religious calendar.

SUN SOLSTICE

The mid-summer celebration and Aicruae's grandest holiday. On this day, temples of Razar, light great bonfires, and people pray for abundance under the ever-bright summer sun. The kingdom's most important religious festival.

FOLK ANIMISM

Traditional belief in spirits of trees, rivers, and mountains that persists among peasants and highlanders in Aicruae. Tolerated by the Circle of Eternal Light only if these practices mix harmlessly with official rites. Not considered heretical unless practiced in isolation from the state religion.

STATE AND FOLK CULTS

The Circle of Eternal Light is the state-sponsored religion of Aicruae; all citizens are expected to show reverence to its gods. Local or minority cults exist only discreetly. Atheism is extremely rare and frowned upon (neighboring Coelum's near-atheism is viewed as a tragic anomaly). See also: CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT, FOLK ANIMISM, THE ORDER OF THE PURE ONES.

PEKNA (PLURAL: PEKNAS)

Triangular temples where local worship occurs. Smaller than the Cidet but serve as community religious centers for those practicing the religion of the circle of eternal light. Each Pekna has priests (and priestesses) led by a High Priest of that temple's deity. See also: PEKNAS.

GRILLED FLATBREADS

A common street food sold at festivals in Aicruae. Topped with olive oil, garlic, and cheese, thought to be inspired by recipes from Pireaynea's culture. A popular treat among both nobles and commoners.

HONEY CAKES

Sweet cakes made with local honey, reflecting Aicruae's widespread enjoyment of sweetened baked goods. Often served alongside fruit preserves at family gatherings and celebrations.

FRUIT PRESERVES

Preserved fruits (particularly strawberries, blackberries, and blueberries) that are both eaten as treats and used to sweeten other dishes. A staple of Aicruae's cuisine, especially during winter months when fresh fruit is unavailable.

CHEESE AND HERB DUMPLINGS

A common Aicruaeian dish, especially popular in cooler months. Dumplings filled with kas (local cheese) and fresh herbs, often served in broth or alongside stews.

STUFFED CABBAGE ROLLS

A traditional Aicruaeian dish consisting of cabbage leaves stuffed with minced meat, grains, and herbs. Commonly prepared in autumn when cabbages are harvested in abundance.

SMOKED SAUSAGES

Sausages spiced with pepper and sage, a common fare especially in cooler months. Preservation techniques for smoking were influenced by Vikitsv's culinary traditions, brought home by Aicruan sailors.

PORRIDGE

A common breakfast food among Aicruaeian peasants and nobles alike, made from oats, barley, or wheat. Often sweetened with honey or served with fresh berries when in season.

POTAGE

A thick vegetable soup or stew that forms the basis of simple peasant suppers throughout Aicruae. Made with whatever vegetables are in season, thickened with grains or bread.

MEAT PIES

Savory pies filled with minced pork and root vegetables, enclosed in thick crusts. A staple of Aicruaeian village fare and traveling food, as they keep well and can be eaten cold.

ROAST LAMB

Aicruae is known for succulent roast lamb seasoned with garlic and rosemary. A common dish at special occasions and harvest feasts.

FISH CHOWDER

A coastal specialty: fish chowders enriched with cream, made from the abundant catches of herring, cod, and mackerel from Aicruae's long coastlines.

SALTED COD

Dried salted cod preserved for long storage and trade. An important trade good from Aicruae's coastal towns, particularly the Northern Isles. The preservation technique allows fish to be transported far inland.

ALES AND BEERS

Brewed from barley and hops, more common in northern Aicruae where grapes for wine are scarce. Farmers produce ales for local consumption, though wine remains the preferred drink in southern and western regions.

COFFEE AND TEA

Introduced to Aicruae through Equateiyan merchants. By the late pre-imperial era also known as Solis's Era, Remains an elite indulgence rather than common fare.

GOLDEN DESSERT WINE

A renowned sweet wine produced by a famous vineyard near Lajazer. Popular in foreign courts and considered one of Aicruae's finest exports.

FESTIVAL OF VAPAZ

Midwinter holy day in Aicruae honoring Vapaz the Sky-King. A solemn celebration featuring quiet vigils under the stark night sky. Aicruans light candles in triangular lanterns (echoing the Pekna temple shape) and offer prayers for guidance through hardship, believing Vapaz's firmament watches over them even in the darkest days.

FEAST OF PLENTY

Autumn harvest festival in Aicruae giving thanks to the entire Pantheon. Each god and goddess receives offerings laid out in a communal temple ceremony. Features

competitions in music and poetry alongside enormous quantities of food and wine. As much cultural as religious in nature, exemplifying Aicruae's love of celebration.

GHERCI

Large kingdom northeast of Aicruae. Known for deep religious devotion to the Circle of Eternal Light, where kings are seen as god-chosen. Ancient, populous nation with a powerful priestly hierarchy. Aicruae's closest ally, sharing religious and cultural bonds, historic alliances, and royal intermarriage. Capital: Tarmet. Relations with Aicruae characterized by extensive trade (Aicruae supplies food and fish; Gherci supplies temple wares, cloth, pilgrims). Sometimes viewed Aicruae as a junior partner due to Gherci's immense size and theocratic rigidity.

PIREAYNEA

Kingdom immediately east of Aicruae. Founded by a Ghercian exile, viewed by neighbors as a lawless, "sketchy" country filled with bandits. Capital: Civer. Uniquely worships the earth goddess Allan as one supreme deity (monotheism), considered odd or blasphemous by Aicruae's clergy. Relations with Aicruae characterized by distrust, porous troubled borders, bandit raids, smuggling, and occasional minor border wars. Trade minimal and unofficial despite Pireaynea's crop abundance.

COELUM

Northern kingdom known as "the Forsaken Place." Ravaged by past misrule, famine, and debt with little to offer economically. Does not border Aicruae directly (lies north of Gherci). Population is mostly atheist, feeling abandoned by the gods—a stance Aicruae views as a tragic outcome of suffering rather than threatening heresy. Currency (Opeali) holds "little to no trading value" abroad. Aicruae maintained relations of neutral pity, occasionally shipping humanitarian grain aid during famines.

EQUATEIY

Wealthy kingdom in the northeastern highlands. Known as the richest country in the world, famed for banking houses and jewel mines. Capital features bold, elaborate fashion flaunting riches. Relations with Aicruae characterized by cautious rivalry—outwardly polite but privately full of wariness. Equateiy’s cosmopolitan, wealth-driven culture contrasted with Aicruae’s traditional piety. Known to meddle in Aicruan politics by funding dissident nobles or rival claimants.

VIKITSV

Cold, mountainous kingdom to the east across the Fetora Sea. Known as having the coldest climate in the world atop Mount Aicren. Famed center of learning and craftsmanship, producing extraordinary scholars, artisans, fine metallurgy (astrolabes, clockwork mechanisms, superior steel weapons). Limited farmland, relies on food imports. Relations with Aicruae characterized by pragmatic neutrality—trade in goods and academic exchange without formal alliance. Aicruan nobility sometimes sent children to study in Vikitsv’s academies. Vikitsv’s secular, scholarly orientation contrasted with Gherci’s theocracy.

CALENDAR GLOSSES (EARTH-TO-AICRUAЕ)

Earth-like month names (such as “June 14”) that appear in authorial notes are convenience glosses for readers. Each Earth month corresponds to a month in the in-world Aicruae calendar:

January = Yita
February = Dar
March = Lac
April = Ni
May = Saer
June = Ocinyi
July = Fasteri Adei
August = Fasteri Adeo
September = Lacai
October = Baer
November = Niserfa
December = Agariso
(13th Month) = Agarisono

See also: ETERNAL SIGNS, MONTHS OF THE SOLISIAN YEAR.

AGARISONO

The thirteenth month of the calendar, created by the death of Harnua Kulio - the thirteenth and final Saint. Agarisono is 40 days long. When Harnua was burned at the stake by Emperor Solis in 7,214 BR, her death (as the last Saint) generated enough divine energy to alter the calendar itself, adding a new month to the year. This follows the established worldbuilding rule that Saints' deaths create calendar months. See also: HARNUA KULIO (In Story Characters), SAINTS (Religion).

Type: Calendar Month

Duration: 40 days

Position: Thirteenth month of the year

Creation: Inaugurated upon Harnua Kulio's death (7, 214BR)

Significance: Created when Harnua raised a second moon with her dying breath. The month honors both her death and the moon she created in Orcus's honor.

JONATHAN KIVA / JANRANO KIVA

The alias used by Solis Elias Patton during his approximately 20 years of exile following the twins' coup. Under this name, Solis trained as a mercenary and built an army of 30,000 men before returning to claim the throne. [NOTE: The source material uses both "Jonathan Kiva" and "Janrano Kiva" confirm which spelling is canon, or whether one is the Ananara version and the other a common-tongue version.] See also: SOLIS ELIAS PATTON (In Story Characters).

THE GOLDEN KING

An epithet given to Emperor Solis Elias Patton after his marriage to Esterica Kulio during Civil War Year Two (7,220 BR). The title refers both to his distinctive blonde hair (inherited from his father, King Benjamin II) and to the golden age his supporters believed he would usher in. Historically, Solis is also referred to as "the king of light and bringer of the new age." See also: THE GREAT USURPER, THE GODLY BASTARD.

THE GODLY BASTARD

A derogatory nickname used by the twins (Iris and Orcus) for their half-brother Solis, referencing both his illegitimate birth (son of a concubine) and the court's

near-worship of him. Orcus references this name in his death speech: "Iris and I used to call you the godly bastard." See also: SOLIS ELIAS PATTON (In Story Characters).

ETERNAL SIGNS (ZODIAC SYSTEM)

The Solisian Empire's astrological system, tied to the thirteen months of the year. Each month has a corresponding Eternal Sign believed to reflect the characteristics of souls born during that time.

Core Belief: The Circle of Eternal Light teaches that a soul never truly dies unless corrupted. Souls live through multiple lifetimes, and an Eternal Sign represents the idea that no matter what body you are born into, your soul will always be born in a certain month and reflect that month's characteristics.

The Thirteen Eternal Signs:

1

Important Note on Interpretation:

When Earth zodiac terms like "Taurus" appear in authorial notes, they are shorthand—"Taurus" corresponds to Baerin in the canonical system. Additionally, harsh trait descriptions (such as "incapable of love" for Garisano) are folk attributions: polemical astrology used socially as stereotypes rather than literal fates. Characters may use these stereotypes to judge others, but they are not deterministic.

See also: CALENDAR GLOSSES, MONTHS OF THE SOLISIAN YEAR, CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT.

Battle of Relirian

The final battle of Saint Reron, where he was ambushed by those who killed his family. He ensured no one survived.

Allironek

Legendary weapon created by the god Finore in honor of Saint Aliirusk after retrieving his body.

Mirrors of Nimlye

A mirror created by the goddess Nimlye to house the body of Saint Eren after the gods deemed him unworthy of burial in their kingdom. Finore refined it into a necklace that Nimlye wears at all times. (Note: Separate from the cursed mirrors in the myth)

BR

Stands for before reconstruction or before Empress Crandona Sareleia Patton gave birth to her Son, Emperor Goteivati Zivc Patton III, who ushered the empire into the Dark Ages and changed the culture of the empire. From Matsiali(A more liberal and free culture, a culture which held respect for females, and one where females were dominant) → Pataoiut (A more conservative and strict culture, A culture with respect for males, and where males are dominant). This change came with the reign of Goteivati III, a tyrannical king who disrespected his wife and even cut up one of her lovers and made her eat him before killing her and their children. Renouncing the old Matsiali ways and saying men were better as they were designed, they were designed by god. Then, creating Pataouit, the culture of worshipping men. He then went on to be named Goteivati the damned. The cultural system of worshipping men, created by Goteivati III after he renounced the old Matsiali ways and declared that men were better "as they were designed by god." Goteivati III was a tyrannical king who disrespected his wife, cut up one of her lovers and forced her to eat him, then killed her and their children. After creating Pataouit, he was named Goteivati the Damned. Despite Emperor Astyan II's reforms approximately 780 years before Minara's era, Pataouit culture - with its male dominance, conservative values, and hierarchical structures - persists as the empire's cultural foundation during Crown of Glory. Karniode Vesmen's arc directly confronts Pataouit: raised by parents who told her that her sole purpose was to marry and have children, she fights to prove that girls can do anything boys can. Referenced across A Princess in Love and A Crown of Glory (Books 3-4).

AR

Stands for after reconstruction or the period directly after the birth of Emperor Goteivati Zivc Patton III.

WEEKDAYS

The Solisian week consists of seven days, each named after a god from the Circle of Eternal Light pantheon. The days are: Vapaz (equivalent to Monday), Razar, Finore, Nellebrie, Nimlye, Zopha, and Allan (equivalent to Sunday). Allan is the customary rest and market day throughout Aicruae. See also: VAPAZ, RAZAR, FINORE, NELLEBRIE, NIMLYE, ZOPHA, ALLAN, CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT.

MATSIALI

Type: Cultural-Religious Ideology

Era: Pre-0 AR (dominant culture before the Dark Ages)

Status: Abolished by imperial decree in 36 AR; effectively destroyed

Core Beliefs: Valued female leadership, sexual freedom, and balance of power between genders. Women held positions of authority. Matriarchal inheritance was common. Female education was widespread. Saints like Duri and Siriande honored as paragons.

Abolition: Emperor Goteivati III condemned it as “weak and corrupt” and replaced it with Pataoiut.

Legacy: Survived in fragments — stories of saints, legal codes (Yerian Laws, Code of Esa), and private family practices.

See Also: PATAOIUT, GOTEIVATI III

PATAOIUT

Type: Cultural-Religious Ideology

Era: 36 AR onward

Created By: Emperor Goteivati Zivc Patton III (“Goteivati the Damned”)

Status: Culturally persistent into Minara’s era despite reforms

Core Beliefs: Aggressively conservative, male-dominated ideology. Demands worship of men as earthly representatives of divine will. Women forced into subservience. Male superiority framed as divinely ordained.

Reforms: Emperor Astyan II (~ 1, 852 AR) reversed worst cruelties but fundamental cultural assumptions remained.

By Minara's Era: Technically post-reform, but cultural damage persists.

See Also: MATSIALI, GOTEIVATI III, ASTYAN II

PEOPLE OF THE SKY

Origin: ~ 28, 490BR (Fall of the Lesser Gods)

Description: Lesser gods who accepted Vapaz's punishment after War of Gods I. Stripped of divinity and cast down to live among mortals. Intermarried with Sun-Forged humans and dispersed across the world.

Relationship to Mortals: Fully integrated; their divine heritage diluted over millennia through mortal bloodlines.

See Also: PEOPLE OF THE MOUNTAIN, FALL OF THE LESSER GODS

PEOPLE OF THE MOUNTAIN

Origin: ~ 28, 490 BR (Fall of the Lesser Gods)

Description: Lesser gods who rejected Vapaz's judgment after War of Gods I. Gathered atop the mountain that would become Vikistv, waiting centuries to reclaim power.

The Verna Bargain: Eventually, Grand Mage Verna struck a bargain with Iswan: "Take my blood and soul, all that I have to divinity, and create-and we shall honor you, we shall never aspire to divinity again." Iswan agreed. The magic she gave them corrupted their souls, making them neither divine nor mortal — vulnerable to sun and fire.

Modern Descendants: Magic users of Vikistv; persecuted after Solis's conquest.

The Four Territories

Aseraga, Baeistic, Urdeio, and Feacener; the territories that would go on to form the country of Pireayena. Saint Karniode may have originated from one of these.

Three Lines of Sin

Saint Malign's famous quote: "The essence of human existence encompasses three fundamental imperatives: the necessity to live, the imperative to create, and the inevitability of destruction."

Tanya's

Public hospitals, created by Saint Duri.

Ilkai

A god-killing herb used by Harnua Kulio in her attempt to assassinate Emperor Solis. A rare and extremely powerful herb capable of killing a god. Ilkai is the most dangerous substance in the known world - its very existence is a closely guarded secret among those with divine knowledge. Harnua Kulio obtained Ilkai through a deal with the goddess Nellebrie and used it in an attempt to assassinate Emperor Solis, but Empress Esterica accidentally drank the poisoned cup instead. The herb's ability to destroy divine beings makes it one of the few known threats to the gods themselves. See also: FAZEN, HARNUA KULIO (In Story Characters), NELLEBRIE (Religion).

A god-killing herb that grows only on Mount Aicren, in places where Nellebrie's disaster-creation and Iswan's alchemical influence overlap. Discovered by Vekta and Aryanara during their studies of the soul

cycle. Ilkai does not simply kill the body—it shatters the soul. The pieces try to return to Noirta separately, and none are whole enough to rejoin. Those who die from Ilkai are forced to walk the Pertari Stairs until the end of time. It is called "god-killing" because it does what even the gods cannot: it ends a soul permanently. The herb is extraordinarily rare; most who attempt the three-month journey up Mount Aicren die before reaching it. Knowledge of its existence is guarded carefully within Vikitsv's scholarly circles and by House Orana and the Magic Tower. Using Ilkai is considered worse than murder. Nellebrie told Harnua Kulio where it grows, and Harnua used it in her attempt to assassinate Emperor Solis.

Type: Divine Herb/Poison

Description: A god-killing herb capable of bypassing divine protection.

Known Use: Harnua Kulio used Ilkai (with Nellebrie's help) in attempt to assassinate Emperor Solis (7, 214BR). Esterica Kulio accidentally drank the poisoned cup instead.

Rarity: Extremely rare; requires divine assistance to obtain or use effectively.

Book Reference: A TALE OF A THOUSAND SONGS

FAZEN

A lethal poison that kills within seconds and leaves virtually no trace in the victim's body. Fazen is one of the most feared substances in Aicruae, prized by assassins for its speed and undetectability. Its properties make it nearly impossible to prove poisoning as a cause of death. See also: ILKAI, JOYLESS DEATH (if separate entry exists for House Vika's poison).

Pertari Stairs

The Pertari Stairs are not a place but a condition-what happens to a soul that has become too discordant to rejoin Noirta's song. When a corrupted soul's body dies, it tries to return to the cycle but cannot. The soul reaches for Noirta and finds only endless climbing, hearing echoes of the Song above but never arriving. The Stairs predate the gods themselves. No divine power has ever retrieved a soul from them. The Circle of Eternal Light teaches the Stairs are a natural consequence of self-inflicted soul corruption. The Brotherhood of Westwinds teaches they are a prison built by the New Gods to punish those who resist their authority. The truth is that neither faith fully understands the Stairs-they emerged from Noirta before consciousness existed to study them.

NERAI

An elixir ingredient referenced in early chapters of A Tale of a Thousand Songs. Queen Mihai is noted as drinking Nerai. [Further details TBD - may need confirmation on its exact properties and whether it's medicinal, recreational, or something else.]

LIACAION

The universe's equivalent of gasoline - a highly flammable liquid used as an accelerant. Liacaion was notably used by Emperor Solis during the extermination of House Orana, when he ordered the entire family burned alive in retaliation for Grand Sorcerer Sevtor's magical attack on Valea that killed 15,000 people. See also: HOUSE ORANA (Noble Houses).

Corruption (Soul Corruption)

When a soul changes so fundamentally that it no longer resonates with Noirta's song. Corruption is not about morality—a soul can lie, steal, and murder and still return to the cycle. The Song judges harmony, not sin. A soul becomes corrupted when the note it sings becomes unrecognizable to the greater melody. There are four known paths to corruption: wrath unchecked (the oldest, where a soul becomes violence itself), the Ilkai herb (external shattering of the soul), magical debt at the Javehet level (trading fundamental soul-notes for power), and voluntary corruption (weary souls deliberately seeking an ending after many lifetimes). Corruption is permanent and irreversible. Corrupted souls are condemned to the Pertari Stairs.

Garden of Unspoken Names

The prison where Renedin, the Old God of dreams and thresholds, waits partially awake. Guarded by Nimlye, goddess of secrets and fate. Renedin is not fully imprisoned—he can send dreams to mortals from the Garden, and has used this ability to influence the Brotherhood of Westwinds through their founder Oleahak and through the Tome of Renedin. His goal is to break free and unmake the additions to the original cosmos, returning reality to its primordial state where his domain of dreams would have equal footing with physical reality.

Qanyaso

A mortal fisherman from myth, rumored to have fathered Saint Karniode with the goddess Zopha (considered mythological, not confirmed).

Battle of Wena

The battle where Saint Aliirusk died while promoting peace, triggering the gods' punishment of humanity.

Tragedy of Enaner

The deaths of Saint Aliirusk's family following his death at the Battle of Wena. Though they did not receive the gods' punishment, humans falsely blamed them for the misfortune befalling their community.

MONTHS OF THE SOLISIAN YEAR

The Solisian calendar consists of thirteen months, each 30 days long except for the thirteenth month (Agarisono), which has 40 days. Each month was created following the death of a Saint.

Month	Days	Created After Death Of
Yita	30	Saint Aliirusk
Dar	30	Saint Bura
Lac	30	Saint Galamma
Ni	30	Saint Dorthargel
Saer	30	Saint Eren
Ocinyi	30	Saint Argellon
Fasteri Adei	30	Saint Siriande
Fasteri Adeo	30	Saint Nairan
Lacai	30	Saint Karniode
Baer	30	Saint Malign
Niserfa	30	Saint Duri
Agariso	30	Saint Reron
Agarisono	40	Saint Harnua

The thirteenth month, Agarisono, was added after Saint Harnua (the controversial 13th Saint) was burned at the stake by Solis. Before dying, she used her saintly power to raise a second moon in Orcus's honor.

See also: ETERNAL SIGNS, CALENDAR GLOSSES.

RERN

The currency of Aicruae. Stable and widely recognized across the continent, reflecting Aicruae's active participation in regional trade. One Rern was roughly valued at the equivalent of 20 USD, indicating substantial purchasing power. The combination of fishing, farming, and trading generated approximately 150 billion Rern annually for the kingdom. Equivalent to approximately one day's labor for a common worker, providing practical baseline for prices and wages. Smaller denominations exist for daily transactions. Aicruae maintains some usage of older local currency alongside the Rern. When Solis absorbed the other kingdoms to create the Solisian Empire, The Rern became standard currency for the empire. Though Common people rarely handle full Rern coins, instead using fractional currency for food, basic goods, and services.

Aicruaeen STEEL PLOWS

A coveted agricultural tool crafted by Aicruan blacksmiths. Known for improving agricultural yields, these plowshares were among the high-quality products of Aicruae's small-scale metalworking industry, alongside farming tools and weapons for the royal army.

GRAND TRUNK ROAD

The main artery of Aicruae's road network. Runs from the old western capital site (near modern Hadiber) through the central city of Lajazer and eastward to Haleker. Maintained by royal decree, paved or well-packed, allowing horse-drawn carts to traverse even mountainous sections with relative ease.

AICRUAЕ-GHERCI CORRIDOR

The primary overland trade route linking Aicruae to the eastern states, passing through Gherci and Pireaynea. Whoever controlled this corridor effectively controlled trade between the western coast and the central/eastern continent. Pireaynea's lawlessness made this route dangerous; Aicruae and Gherci cooperated on securing it with fortified caravanserais.

FRUIT TARTS AND PIES

A beloved Aicruaeen treat. Bakers layer apples, pears, and raisins into flaky pastries sweetened with local honey or imported sugar, often spiced with cinnamon or nutmeg from distant markets. A fixture at festivals and celebrations.

SPICED SWEETFRUIT CAKE

A popular dessert in wealthier Aicruan circles. A yeasted tart filled with stewed plums or peaches. One recipe records layering dough with an apple-pear-raisin paste and glazing it with spiced wine syrup for extra richness.

CIVER

The capital of Pireaynea, A town along the Aicruae-Gherci trade corridor, located in Pireaynea. One of the stops where Aicruaeen merchants exchange goods on

their way to Equateiy or Vikitsv.

TARMET

The capital of Gherci, A city along the Aicruae-Gherci trade corridor. A trading stop in the overland route between Aicruae and the eastern states.

HENEM BAY

Coelum's northern bay. Some Aicruan trade ships sailed north then east to loop toward Henem Bay, though Coelum's poverty meant limited trade volume. An inland sea bay in the north of the continent. Gherci has a short coastline on the southern portion of Henem Bay, where the humid and mild climate fosters vibrant port cities and gardens. Coelum's northern coast also touches the bay. Some Aicruae trade ships sailed north then east to loop toward Henem Bay, though Coelum's poverty meant limited trade volume. Gherci's ports on the bay are more active, serving as entry points for pilgrims and trade goods heading to the kingdom's interior.

OBERYA SEA

The sea on the far eastern side of the continent. Aicruaeans vessels would sail around the continent's southern cape to reach the Obery Sea, trading with Equateiy and Vikitsv via long-distance sea lanes.

THE GREAT RIVER

A major river flowing from near Coelum down through Gherci and presumably into Pireaynea. Does not run through Aicruae itself, but smaller Aicruan rivers fulfill a similar role for internal river transport on a local scale.

Pireaynean NOODLES

Pasta-like noodles that entered Aicruae cuisine through Pireaynea's proximity and culinary traditions. Part of the foreign influence enriching Aicruae's food culture through trade.

Pireaynean CHEESES

Ricotta-style cheeses originating from Pireaynea's traditions. Adopted into Aicruan cuisine through trade and cultural exchange with the neighboring kingdom.

THE FIRST ARMY

One of two royal military groups loyal directly to the crown and heirs of House Patton, Combined with the Second Army, totals 200,000 soldiers.

CONTRACEPTIVES

Creator: King Hailour Layern Patton II

Date of Creation: 8,660 BR

Effective Rate: 41%

Side Effects:

- Nausea
- Stomach Pains
 - Spotting
- Fevers
- Swelling in blood vessels and stomach
- Fatigue
- Death (Uncommon but possible)

Components:

- Pink Haillet Petals
- Lemon
- Honey
- Papaya Juice
- Crushed Papaya Seed

Context: King Hailour II invented Aicruae's first known contraceptives after his wife Queen Isalian said she only wanted two children. The research took three years to complete.

THE SECOND ARMY

The second of House Patton's royal military forces. Soldiers are loyal to the crown and heirs.

THE IVERAS

A mercenary organization commanded exclusively by House Vika. Total force of 270,000 men.

THE SWORDS OF MERTYERIA

Military organization working exclusively for House Vika. Total force of 40,000 men.

THE SWORDS OF AISHAE

Weapons/organization associated with House Arvento (listed among their achievements).

THE SIEGE OF HIGHWATER (7, 463 BR)

A large-scale uprising inspired by Bloody Winter that unfolded near Aicruae's capital during a historic flood called Highwater. Mobs of peasants and disenfranchised soldiers laid siege to the capital, attempting to topple the noble government.

THE BATTLE OF LITTLE HILL & THE BATTLE OF BEARS (8,264-8,262 BR)

Two separate battles caused by the same person (Taverlo) within two years. Began when a servant named Yujari and her brother Taverlo poisoned a cruel merchant named Hafen. After Yujari was burned at the stake while pregnant, Taverlo escaped and rallied peasants into rebellion. T

THE MEDALS OF SOALM

Medals of honor given by the Cidet for upholding the order of the gods. Among the hardest medals to obtain. Gold: Medal of Sun. Silver: Medal of the Ocean and Air. Bronze: Medal of the Land and

Moon. Recipients include Hailour I (posthumous), Hailour II (posthumous), and King Consort Teravian Patton.

QUARTI MEDAL

A medal given for remarkable sea voyages that bring great honor to a country or individual. Awarded to members of House Leva including Xanti Leva and Vargua Leva I.

THE RISE AND FALL OF A KING (TEXT)

Author: Kyatane Arvento

Type: Political/Philosophical Treatise

Subject: The moral duties and potential downfalls of monarchs

Summary: A treatise on kingship that argues kings are stewards appointed by the gods rather than divine beings themselves. The text outlines how monarchs must maintain purity of heart and clarity of mind, share sacrifice with their people in wartime, speak truthfully, act justly, and exercise wisdom even in generosity. It identifies five fatal flaws that lead to a king's downfall: Greed, Selfishness, Blood Hunger, Cowardice, and Stupidity/Ignorance. The text concludes that a king's fate ultimately rests with the people's judgment.

Notable Quotes: See QUOTE BANK under Kyatane Arvento

1. What Causes the Fall of a King; (SCBSG) GREED, SELFISHNESS, BLOOD HUNGER, COQARDICE, STUPIDY/IGNORGANCE.

DES

A formal title meaning "distant relative," reserved exclusively for those with viable royal blood belonging to the royal family of Aicruae. More respectful than the common term "Der."

DER

Common term for distant relatives without royal connections used within Aicruae.

ASHANTI

Lower-level nobles who own land and rule over their territories. The term literally refers to people who own and govern land within Aicruae.

PIESTO

High government officials including lawyers, guards, and enforcers of the law. They can have an audience with the king and supervise common citizens and knights within Aicruae.

THE COUNCIL OF THE FORSAKEN

Investigative body created by Houses Arvento, Aedria, and Caraen to investigate violent crimes. Has crown approval, operates across territories, and has reduced crime by 30% since founding. Greatly feared throughout Aicruae.

THE LAND UNDER THE SUN

Nickname for Aicruae, referring both to the beautiful climate and the country's primary devotion to Razar (Sun God).

LAJAZER

The capital city of Aicruae, built "on top of a giant mountain-like cliff" following King Hailour's divine dream of two panthers.

LIAZEN

What Liazen Was:

- Geographic/Political Entity:
 - A. A "small piece of flourishing land" within what would become Aicruae
 - B. Operated as its own semi-independent "country" for roughly 50 years (8, 720BR to 8, 662BR)
 - C. A territory that "had not fully bowed to the Aicruae Royal Family/House

Patton"

D. Eventually absorbed into Aicruae in 8,662 BR

- Economic Status:
 - A. Extremely wealthy and prosperous
 - B. Had notable businesses that generated significant wealth
 - C. The Liazen treasury was so valuable that Queen Isalian's dowry alone was twice the size of the entire royal Aicruaeen treasury
- The Liazen Royal Family:
 - A. His Majesty Janian Liazen (8,760 BR - 8,680 BR)
- Father of Jinegi Liazen
- Founder and first ruler of independent Liazen
- Established Liazen as a semi-independent territory around 8, 720BR when he was approximately 40 years old as a Resistance to House Patton's expansion, and for Economic independence (protecting trade routes/businesses).
- Built "notable businesses" in international trade involving textiles and mining. That made Liazen so wealthy.
- Died in 8,680 BR, leaving his son Jinegi (age 42) to inherit
 - B. Queen Tavessa Liazen (8, 755 BR - 8,685 BR)
- Mother of Jinegi Liazen
- Wife of King Janian Liazen
- From a wealthy merchant family, bringing resources/connections that helped establish Liazen's independence
- Died shortly before her husband.
 - C. His Majesty Jinegi Liazen (8,722 BR - 8,660 BR)
- Originally held the title "His Majesty" as ruler of independent Liazen
- Later titled "Count" Jinegi Liazen after negotiating with King Ilaem Nefest Patton I
- Married to Lady Naern Mena

- Killed in the territorial dispute of 8,662BR
D. Lady Naern Mena (8,716 BR - 8,660 BR)
- Wife of Jinegi Liazen
- 1st Twin Daughter of Princess Aliedea Cawiloan Patton and Duke Nayiler Mena
- This means she had royal Aicruae blood through her mother (who was daughter of King Hailour Layern Patton I)
- Killed in the territorial dispute of 8,662 BR
E. Queen Isalian Liazen (8,670 BR - 8,590 BR)
- Daughter of His Majesty Jinegi Liazen and Lady Naern Mena
- Survived the territorial dispute at age 8
- Last surviving member of the main branch of the Liazen royal family
- Later became Queen of Aicruae
F. Lady Agari Liazen (8,663 BR - 8,660 BR)
- Younger sister of Isalian
- Daughter of His Majesty Jinegi Liazen and Lady Naern Mena
- Only 3 years old during the territorial dispute
- Died from illness before age 4 , unable to handle the trauma of fleeing

✓ NOTES:

Connection to House Patton:

The Liazen royal family already had blood ties to House Patton through Lady Naern Mena: Naern's mother was Princess Aliedea Cawiloan Patton (daughter of King Hailour Layern Patton I)

Naern's grandmother was Queen Walica Kevena Patton (1st Queen of Aicruae) So when Isalian married King Hailour Layern Patton II, she was actually marrying a distant relative - they shared King Hailour Layern Patton I as a common ancestor (he was her great-great-grandfather). The Bumpy History: Isalian wasn't initially approved for marriage to the king. She wasn't allowed to take the Patton surname. There was lingering distrust despite the family connection because Liazen wouldn't bow to Aicruae for some time.

BASAR TARI

Southern prison colony of Aicruae and unofficial hub of the UIB (Underground Illegal Business). Most guards and officials have been corrupted, creating a criminal center under the crown's nose.

HALEKER

Territory controlled by House Vika of Aicruae. Known for harsh, brutal punishments administered faster and with less due process than elsewhere in Aicruae.

RERN

The currency of Aicruae. 1 Rern = approximately \$20 USD.

THE UIB (UNDERGROUND ILLEGAL BUSINESS)

A loose network of criminal enterprises operating primarily in Southern Aicruae. Not a single organization but multiple competing groups with territorial agreements. Deals in prohibited goods, smuggling, assassination, information brokering, and human trafficking.

TRAVELING MERCHANTS

Commercial traders who travel in caravans throughout Aicruae, usually hiring guards for protection. They maintain their own information networks about road conditions and safe inns.

TAL-SEL

TAL-SEL (Wedding/Festival Dance)

A traditional marriage dance where the couple dances in a circle, hands interlocked with each other. They pull away from each other and then back together over and over until one side gives in. It is supposed to symbolize the willingness to forgive and love the other person unconditionally-to give up part of your soul for your lover.

ANSARI

THE ANSARI

Traditional partner dance popular in Aicruae, though created by Queen Mansari of Gherci.

Steps:

1. The two people spin around in a circle around one another, taking turns as the other partner watches and waits for their turn.
2. The two partners then bow and proceed to a simple 1, 2, 3 ballroom dance.
3. The dance ends as it started, with the two people spinning around in a circle around one another, taking turns as the other partner watches and waits for their turn.
4. At the end of the dance, the people dancing spin around in a circle around each other, clapping their hands to the beat of the song.
5. The men continue clapping while the woman spins around dancing.

Note: The dance was created by Queen Mansari of Gherci but is very popular in Aicruae.

CARTOSE

CARTOSE

A less formal group dance in Aicruae, a kind of waltz. The dance starts off with the ladies dancing with each other while the men watch on the sidelines. The song pauses in the middle, and during that time a woman is prompted to walk up to a man and give him money (usually a small sum) to signify that she is willing to bet on him-his future, his affections for her, or that she simply likes him enough to.

SUN SICKNESS

Local term in Western Aicruae for heat exhaustion and death from overwork in extreme heat. Families commonly lose 1-2 members per generation to this condition.

JOYLESS DEATH

JOYLESS DEATH

Date of Creation: 8,864 BR Creator: Yarsi Vika Plant: Nerai

Description: A poison made from Nerai, a toxic yellow plant found in Eastern Aicruae in the town of Haleker.

Toxicity: Extremely Toxic or Deadly

How It Is Made:

1. Crush the purple stem of the plant.
2. Add two drops of water to the crushed stems.
3. Mix the stem powder and the water gradually together until a water-like consistency is achieved.

How It Works: Nerai targets parts of the nervous system and the brain, putting the body in a state of shock before almost instantly killing the person who consumes it.

Where It Can Be Found:

- Produced by House Vika for the Ivera's and The Swords of Mertyeria use under direction.
- Sold illegally at undercover stores (Rare Find)

THE BATTLE OF LITTLE HILL & THE BATTLE OF BEARS (8,264-8,262 BR)

Two separate battles within two years, sparked by the same chain of events. A servant named Yujari and her older brother Taverlo poisoned their cruel master Hafen, a wealthy merchant who abused his servants. When Hafen's half-brother Saut inherited the business and had Yujari burned at the stake while pregnant, Yujari survived and Taverlo rallied local peasants into open rebellion - first against Saut and other high society members (the Battle of Little Hill, 8,264 BR), and then a second campaign two years later (the Battle of Bears, 8,262BR). Taverlo lost the Battle of Bears after being betrayed by his best friend. The name "Battle of Bears" references the bear's link to brotherhood and family - a bitter irony hinting

that Taverlo was ultimately fighting his own “brother” who had been corrupted by the nobles. These battles, followed by Bloody Winter three years later, established the pattern of lower-class uprisings that culminated in the Siege of Highwater centuries later. See also: BLOODY WINTER, THE SIEGE OF HIGHWATER.

NERAI

A toxic yellow plant found in Eastern Aicruae in the town of Haleker. The plant has a purple stem that is crushed to create the poison known as Joyless Death. Extremely toxic or deadly. See: Joyless Death.

INFANT LAWS

Protective laws in Northern Aicruae that, combined with the Arvento Night Soldiers, make The Town of Aishae the safest place for both women and children in all of Aicruae.

Humanitarian laws introduced by House Arvento around 8,683BR, building on the momentum of the Arvento Code. The Infant Laws guaranteed protection for infants and mothers regardless of social class - even children born out of wedlock or in serfdom were entitled to care and safety. In Northern Aicruae, the Infant Laws combined with the Arvento Night Soldiers make the Town of Aishae the safest place for both women and children in all of Aicruae. The laws represent one of the earliest codified humanitarian protections in Aicruan history. See also: THE ARVENTO CODE, ARVENTO NIGHT SOLDIERS.

PATAOIUT

The aggressively conservative, male-dominated culture imposed by Emperor Goteivati III in 36 AR to replace Matsiali. Pataoiut demanded worship of men as earthly representatives of divine will. Under Pataoiut, women were stripped of positions of authority, matriarchal inheritance rights were revoked, female education was outlawed, and men were exalted in all things. Temples were rededicated to male saints and gods. Texts praising past empresses or female heroes were destroyed. The sub-religion of Leneyez was twisted to focus sacrificial offerings on honoring the Emperor and male ancestors rather than the gods. Goteivati elevated himself as the nearly divine apex of this hierarchy. Pataoiut fundamentally remade the empire’s identity - its language, customs, and

religious practices all changed to reflect male superiority. See also: MATSIALI, BR, LENEYEZ.

MATSIALI

The original culture of the Solisian Empire prior to Goteivati III's reign. Matsiali was a liberal, progressive culture that valued female leadership, sexual freedom, and a balance of power between genders. Under Matsiali, women held positions of authority, matriarchal inheritance was recognized, and female education was practiced. The culture honored saints like Duri and Siriande and reflected centuries of reform stretching back to the Yerian Laws. Emperor Goteivati III abolished Matsiali by imperial decree in 36 AR, condemning it as weak and offensive to the gods, and replaced it with Pataoiut. See also: PATAOIUT, BR, YERIAN LAWS.

THE WARRIORS' AGE

The period from roughly 8,900BR to 7,945BR - approximately a thousand years during which the majority of the world's kingdoms were founded. Called the Warriors' Age because of the sheer volume of wars fought during this time, though most conflicts were internal disputes between rival clans and factions vying for control within newly forming nations rather than wars between established countries. Equateiy (8,900BR), Gherci (8,763BR), Aicruae (8,759BR), and Coelum (8,494BR) were all founded during this era. Pireaynea was the only country not founded during the Warriors' Age. See also: CHAMPIONS OF THE WARRIORS AGE.

FESTIVAL OF THE MOON

Annual celebration held on Agariso 30 (December 30) honoring the moon and its associated deities and lore. Held at the very end of the year, just nine days after the Festival of Unity, creating a stretch of late-winter celebration. The moon holds particular significance in the world's mythology - Nimlye's mirrors, the Eternal Signs, and Saint Harnua's raising of the second moon all tie lunar imagery to divine power. See also: FESTIVAL OF UNITY, MIRRORS OF NIMLYE, ETERNAL SIGNS.

DAY OF THE GODS

Annual celebration held on Fasteri Adeo 17 (August 17) honoring the pantheon of the Circle of Eternal Light. A day of reverence dedicated to all twelve gods collectively rather than any single deity. See also: CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT, THE CIDET.

FESTIVAL OF UNITY

Annual celebration held on Agariso 21 (December 21). A festival emphasizing solidarity and togetherness across social classes and regions. Held during the darkest period of winter, the Festival of Unity carries symbolic weight as a reminder that the kingdom endures through collective strength. See also: CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT.

CELEBRATION OF THE SAINTS

Annual celebration held on Lac 24 (March 24) honoring the twelve saints who shaped the world through their divine gifts and mortal sacrifices. Likely the most emotionally charged religious holiday, given the saints' complex legacies - from Aliirusk's selfless peace to Reron's devastating vengeance. See also: CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT, THE ORDER OF THE PURE ONES.

REMEMBERS DAY

Annual observance held on Yita 26 (January 26). A solemn day of remembrance for the dead - likely honoring both fallen soldiers and civilian casualties of Aicruae's many wars and upheavals. See also: CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT.

CELEBRATION OF THE SOLIS EMPIRE

Annual celebration held on Lacai 23 (September 23) commemorating the Solisian Empire. The nature of this celebration likely shifted dramatically depending on the era - a source of pride during the empire's height, and potentially a more complicated observance during and after the Dark Ages under Goteivati III. See also: BR, AR.

MARTYRS' FESTIVAL

Annual observance held on Fasteri Adeo 29 (August 29) honoring those who died for their faith or for the protection of others. Given Aicruae's long history of religious persecution (the Massacre of Light, the deaths of multiple saints, the Blood Trials), this festival carries significant weight. See also: CELEBRATION OF THE SAINTS, THE MASSACRE OF LIGHT, CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT.

PARENTS DAY

Annual celebration held on Niserfa 11 (November 11) honoring mothers and fathers. In a world where family lineage determines noble status, inheritance rights, and political power, Parents Day carries both personal and political significance. See also: INFANT LAWS.

FESTIVAL OF WORSHIP

Annual celebration held on Saer 1 (May 1). A spring festival dedicated to active worship and religious devotion. Likely involves pilgrimages to local Peknas and possibly to the Cidet for those who can make the journey. See also: PEKNAS, THE CIDET, CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT.

FESTIVAL OF THE SUN

Annual celebration held on Ocinyi 14 (June 14) honoring Razar, the Sun God and Aicruae's primary deity. Related to but distinct from the Sun Solstice - the Festival of the Sun is a specifically religious observance of Razar's power, while the Sun Solstice is the broader midsummer cultural celebration. See also: SUN SOLSTICE, RAZAR, THE LAND UNDER THE SUN.

THE AGE OF ORIGIN

The Age of Origin refers to the primordial era when Noirta, the Great Song, first brought existence into being. This was the time before time as mortals understand it - when the first souls were created, when the cycle of rebirth began, and when the fabric of reality was woven from sound and divine intention.

Everything that exists now carries an echo of that original song. Souls are not created anew with each birth but are fragments of that first chorus, cycling

endlessly through mortal forms, carrying pieces of every life they have lived before.

The twin sisters Vekta and Aryanara, founders of the Circle of Eternal Light in 14,271 BR, devoted their lives to teaching humanity about this sacred origin. They traveled the world spreading the truth that death holds no dominion over the soul, that corruption alone can break the cycle, and that the divine order established at creation still governs all existence. Aryanara recorded Vekta's speeches, and these writings became the foundational texts of the Circle.

The lands that briefly bore their names after their deaths were less important than the spiritual inheritance they left behind - a theological tradition that has endured for over fourteen thousand years.

House Catern's motto, "For the age of origin and for the strength of Aryanara and Vekta," declares their role as guardians of this inheritance. They do not protect physical borders so much as defend the foundational truths the sisters revealed. Against competing beliefs like the Brotherhood of Westwinds, which venerates only the gods of old, House Catern stands as a bulwark for the Circle's teachings: that old and new are part of the same eternal song, and that humanity's souls have been singing since the very beginning.

See also: Noirta, Circle of Eternal Light, Vekta and Aryanara, House Catern, Brotherhood of Westwinds

THE ARVENTO CODE

A comprehensive legal code compiled by the scholars and jurists of House Arvento, completed around 8,126 BR during a time of relative peace. The Arvento Code standardized principles of fair taxation, trade rights, and port regulations across Aicruae. It became the de facto constitution of Aicruae's kingdom and was so well-crafted that when Aicruae later grew into the Solisian Empire, the Arvento Code heavily influenced the Imperial Code that governed all nations. Distinct from the earlier Code of Esa - Saint Argellon's Code of Esa established moral and philosophical legal foundations, while the Arvento Code focused on practical governance, commerce, and administration. See also: THE CODE OF ESA, INFANT LAWS.

ARVENTO NIGHT SOLDIERS

A protective force associated with House Arvento that, combined with the Infant Laws, makes The Town of Aishae the safest place for both women and children in all of Aicruae.

ORCUS'S THREE STRONGHOLDS

Bareta, Nyeo, and Valea. (Note: These are listed as "Orcus's future" strongholds that he has during the civil war between the twins and Solis.

STONE POWDER

An illegal drug banned in Aicruae but smuggled and sold through the UIB, imported from Equateiy.

KAN

Posion, typically used for execution created by Sina Arvento specifically for those convicted of horrendous acts like rape or murder. Takes 2 hours to kill, representing a painful, slow death.

PEKNAS

Triangular temples where local worship occurs. Smaller than the Cidet but serve as community religious centers.

THE HALL OF TWELVE

Central sanctuary at the Cidet with altars to all twelve gods arranged in a circle. Pilgrims traditionally circle it, offering prayers at each altar.

THE CODE OF ESA

A governing philosophy for the justice system, emphasizing that "just punishment" should reflect crime severity.

THE CODE OF ESA THE VERSION USED IN AICRUAE

Aicruae's foundational moral-legal canon, introduced by Saint Argellon. The Code blends secular statutes with ethical precepts, unifying government law and personal virtue.

Court Hierarchy:

- Local magistrates (minor nobles or appointed scholars) preside over village and county courts, handling minor civil suits and petty crimes
- Provincial courts hear appeals from local courts
- Royal tribunal in the capital handles serious cases
- King's council reserves judgment on capital crimes and matters of state (treason, regicide, large-scale corruption)

The monarch issues decrees and interpretations of the Code.

Types of Law:

- Criminal laws: theft, assault, murder, sedition, witchcraft, heresy - severely punished
- Civil laws: property, contracts, inheritance (nobles follow primogeniture; commoners may divide land more equally)
- Moral laws: forbid slander, oath-breaking, blasphemy, sedition - violations may incur both religious and secular penalty

Punishments:

- Death: beheading or execution (reserved for crimes against state or religion)
- Exile: to the southern penal colonies, a vast desert prison zone
- Imprisonment: often temporary holding rather than long sentences
- Hard labor: road-building, mining, logging, farming for the crown
- Corporal: flogging, the cangue (wooden collar), branding, amputation for repeated offenses
- Fines and asset forfeiture: for property crimes

Punishment severity may be tempered by the criminal's status.

Enforcement:

- Village constables appointed from trusted villagers
- Royal garrison soldiers patrol towns and trade routes
- Noble retainers keep order on private estates
- The Royal Guard polices the capital and serves writs for high crimes
- Community responsibility: families oversee each other's behavior; communities help identify offenders
- Temple involvement: priests report moral crimes; temple elders arbitrate local disputes

Authority is top-heavy - commoners dare not openly defy nobles or priests due to collective penalties.

YERIAN LAWS

Special statutes instituted by Saint Siriande that protect women's inheritance and land rights. These laws operate within the broader framework of the Code of Esa's civil law provisions.

CANGUE

A wooden collar used as corporal punishment for certain offenses under the Code of Esa.

THE CIDET

Also known as "The Temple of the Gods." The holiest pilgrimage site in relative location to Aicruae, receiving 9 million pilgrims yearly. Contains the Hall of Twelve, the Room of Glory, and the Hero's Hall.

THE ORDER OF THE PURE ONES

A heretical sect that worships human saints instead of gods. Nearly wiped out in the Massacre of Light. Survivors practice in secret, with House Dajanyi being one of the few families still following openly.

CIRCLE OF ETERNAL LIGHT

Contains three distinct sub-religions (Leneyez, Rillic, and Barqeten) that differ in practice but share the same pantheon.

LENEYEZ

One of three sub-religions within the Circle of Eternal Light. Believes in sacrificing people and animals to maintain the gods' physical and spiritual well-being. Followed by Houses Patton, Vika, Vemer, Kulio, Najil, and Hige.

RILIC

The "middle ground" sub-religion. Believes humans fuel gods' strength and give them a tether to the mortal world through service and action, but without blood sacrifice. Followed by Houses Vika (dual practice), Caraen, and Mena.

BARQETEN

The sub-religion emphasizes that simply existing is worship, with focus on physical and mental wellness. Seen as less demanding but also less devout by Leneyez followers. Followed by Houses Arvento, Leva, Aedria, and Yurea.

THE MASSACRE OF LIGHT

Historical event that nearly wiped out the Order of the Pure Ones (the heretical sect worshipping human saints instead of gods).

THE DREAM OF TWO PANTHERS

Divine vision experienced by King Hailour Layern Patton I that led him to relocate the capital to its current location on the mountain-like cliff. Some called him mad, but subsequent economic shifts validated the decision.

THE TERRITORIAL DISPUTE OF 8,662 BR

The conflict that resulted in Liazen's absorption into Aicruae. Occurred because Count Jinegi Liazen lacked full internal support for his deal with King Ilaem Nefest Patton I. Lasted only a few months but resulted in the deaths of Count Jinegi, Lady Naern Mena, and most of the Liazen royal family. Eight-year-old Isalian and three-year-old Agari fled, though Agari died from illness shortly after.

BARIE

Ethnic group. People with typically light to fair skin tones, sometimes with pink or cool undertones. Their noses are often narrow or straight-bridged; the tip may be pointed or softly rounded. Their eyes are usually deep-set with defined eyelid creases in colors like blue, green, grey, hazel, or light brown. Their hair texture is usually straight or wavy and the colors range anywhere from blonde to brown to black to red. With an angular or softly squared jawline, thinner lips that can sometimes be moderately full, cheekbones range from high to mid-set.

TAILI

Ethnic group. People with medium-brown to deep brown skintone that may have warm, olive cool or neutral undertones. Their nose shapes are often broad, curved, rounded, straight or gently flared with the bridge height depending on the region. Their eye shape is often almond shaped or round with their eyelids appearing with a subtle or less pronounced crease but a defined crease is not completely uncommon. Their eye colors are typically lighter to darker brown, sometimes even black similar to that of Guio's, and Nemeris. Their hair texture is typically tightly coiled/tightly curled though density and curl pattern vary widely. Their lips are often full or softly rounded. Their cheekbones may be prominent, their jawlines can be rounded, angular or square.

NEMERI

Ethnic group. People with light golden to deep brown skin tones, with warm to golden undertones though neutral and cool undertones are not uncommon. Their nose shape is usually straight, softly rounded, or slightly broad. Their eye shape is commonly almond shaped. Their eye colors are typically lighter to darker brown,

sometimes even black similar to that of Guio's, and Taili's. Their hair is usually straight, wavy or loosely curled, usually black or dark brown similar to Guio's. Their lips are within the medium-full to full range. Their cheekbones are softly defined or prominent, while their jawlines can be rounded and or angular.

GUIO

Ethnic group. People with typically fair to medium skin tones, with cool neutral or warm undertones. Their eye shape is often almond-shaped, their eyelids have a monolid, or a subtle crease. Their nose shape is usually straight or softly rounded. Their hair is usually straight, wavy or loosely curled, usually black or dark brown similar to Nemeris. Lips are usually medium-full to full. Their lips are within the medium-full to full range. Their cheekbones are softly defined or prominent, while their jawlines can be rounded and or angular.

PROTECTION SPELL

Religious tradition where a priest places a protective "spell" on newborn children. King Benjaen Nefest Patton famously granted this only to his son King Ilaem Nefest Patton I while skipping his daughter Queen Cawiloan Heka Patton entirely, publicly showing his lack of favor toward her

MOTHER SUPERIOR OF AICRUAE

The only title of its kind in Aicruae history, granted exclusively to Queen Isalian Liazen. Recognizes exceptional contributions to the kingdom beyond standard queenly duties. No other woman in Aicruae's history has received this honor.

KING CONSORT

Title given to a male royal spouse when the ruling monarch is female. Example: King Consort Teravian Geraser Patton, husband and brother of Queen Naila Deyua Patton. Unlike standard kings, consorts do not hold primary ruling authority.

THE GREAT LADY OF HOUSE PATTON

Honorary title bestowed upon Queen Cawiloan Heka Patton for giving birth to King Hailour Layern Patton II, recognizing her role in continuing the dynasty's most

significant bloodline.

MOTHER OF THE GREAT AICRUAEAN DYNASTY

Title referring to Queen Walica Kevena Patton, the first official Queen of Aicruae and mother of the founding royal line, though she is often overshadowed by other family members despite this distinction.

THE BENAIN FAMILY

The most powerful family in the region before Aicruae's official founding. Led by Dures the Great (also called Dures Benain), who eventually bowed to King Hailour Layern Patton I and offered his daughter Walica as bride. The family had a "nasty reputation" that transferred to Queen Walica, causing her to be disrespected despite her queenly status.

DURES THE GREAT

Father of Queen Walica Kevena Patton and the most powerful warlord in the region before King Hailour Layern Patton I unified Aicruae. The first major figure to bow to Hailour and acknowledge him as king. Also known as Dures Benain.

THE CASUST FAMILY

Family of Queen Vala Uinara Patton, distantly related to the Benain family through maternal lines. Pavim Casust (father), Malejia Casust (mother), and Kaseieke Casust (younger brother who died in infancy) comprised Vala's immediate family.

HOUSE MENA

Noble house connected to the royal family through Princess Aliedea Cawiloan Patton's marriage to Duke Nayiler Mena. This house produced Lady Naern Mena and Lady Vaseiula Mena, twin daughters who maintained royal bloodlines.

PASSING ON CEREMONY

Funeral rites for deceased royalty. When King Benjaien Nefest Patton died, Queen Cawiloan refused to attend, instead wearing white (mourning color) and visiting

her mother Queen Vala's grave.

THE LIAZEN ROYAL SET

Jewelry collection brought to the royal treasury by Queen Isalian Liazen from her massive dowry, which was twice the size of the entire Aicruaeen royal treasury.

HAILOUR'S FAVORITE COLLECTION

Jewelry collection commissioned by Queen Isalian Liazen, pieces that King Hailour Layern Patton II particularly admired.

THE SNAKE EYE COLLECTION

One of Queen Isalian Liazen's commissioned jewelry collections added to the royal treasury.

THE BREGARIA COLLECTION

Queen Isalian's largest jewelry commission, containing 37+ pieces of flowery jewelry made from gems in her enormous dowry. Reflects her love of flowers.

THE JEWELS OF DAGALREA

Jewelry collection added to the royal treasury by Queen Isalian Liazen.

THE RUINS OF INALIA COLLECTION

Jewelry collection added to the royal treasury by Queen Isalian Liazen.

THE CROWN OF ROSES

Symbolic gift presented by fourteen-year-old King Hailour Layern Patton II to twelve-year-old Isalian Liazen when he won a tournament in 8,658 BR. This public gesture made Isalian acknowledge his feelings for the first time. Represents the turning point in their legendary love story.

THE GREAT THRONE ROOM OF AICRUAE

Designed by Queen Isalian Liazen as one of her many architectural contributions to the kingdom of Aicruae.

THE ROYAL MEETING SPACE OF AICRUAE

Layout and design created by Queen Isalian Liazen for official government functions.

THE ROYAL TRAINING GROUNDS OF AICRUAE

Constructed with Queen Isalian Liazen's help for training knights and soldiers.

BALCONIES

Architectural feature introduced to Aicruae by Queen Isalian Liazen, previously unknown in the region of Aicruae

MESSENGER BIRDS

Communication system concept created by Queen Isalian Liazen as an innovation for the kingdom of Aicruae

ROSE-SCENTED PERFUME

The first perfumes in Aicruae, specifically rose-scented, introduced and helped created by Queen Isalian Liazen.

GREENERY INITIATIVE

Queen Isalian's addition of trees and wildlife around the castle and capital city to combat health issues, specifically cases of people passing out (likely from heat or poor air quality).

THE GRAND WEDDING OF ISALIAN AND HAILOUR

Married in 8,656 BR (two years after the tournament), this ceremony was funded by Queen Isalian's own dowry and was so grand that all of Aicruae was permitted to attend. Their love story inspired countless songs and fantastical tales.

FAMOUS QUOTES:

Historical and Well known Quotes

Queen Isalian Liazen

"No matter how sad the fact is, Queens aren't allowed to be victims..."

Queen Isalian Liazen's famous quote to her daughter Queen Naila Deyua Patton: "No matter how sad the fact is, Queens aren't allowed to be victims. We can be everything else though, Daughters, Wives, and Mothers. My daughter you are going to be queen one day and you must never allow yourself to be anything but what you are. My Daughter. Promise me that." Later quoted by Queen Naila during a meeting with foreign representatives who were frustrated that she ruled instead of her husband, King Consort Teravian Geraser Patton.

King Benjaien Nefest Patton "Old Prude, Worthless Bitch, and the Bane of My

Existence"

Epithets King Benjaien Nefest Patton used to describe his wife Queen Vala Uinara Patton. He resented her because his mother Queen Walica placed her as his wife to control him, and he hated that Vala was older than him and "looked more like a king than him."

QUEEN ISALIAN LIAZEN'S DOWRY

The largest dowry in Aicruaeon history, valued at twice the entire royal treasury at the time of her marriage. Contents included: 17 estates, 42 boxes/crates of silk and furs, 38 full boxes/crates of jewels, and immense amounts of jewelry. This wealth funded the Grand Wedding and many of Queen Isalian's architectural and cultural contributions to the kingdom.

CHAMPIONS OF THE WARRIORS AGE

Title associated with House Patton's achievements during the founding era of Aicruae (8,759 BR). Listed among the house's major accomplishments alongside the Siege of Highwater and Bloody Winter.

CUISINE

CUISINE OF AICRUAЕ

Cakes & Tortes

Spiced Fruit Cake

A yeasted spice torte layered with apple-pear-raisin paste, glazed with sugar syrup tinted pink with cherry or mulberry juice, and topped with strawberries, apple slices, and kiwi. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Iced Peach Cake

A one-layer peach torte with beaten-egg leavening, glazed with rosewater sugar tinted pink via cherries or beet, decorated with poached peach rounds. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Cold Peach Cake

Two thin egg-raised tortes sandwiched with peach conserve loosened with verjuice. Served chilled with no exterior frosting, the only royal cake served without decoration. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Almond Cake

A pale egg-white almond torte made with fine flour, ground almonds, and sugar, topped with sautéed apple and peach in honey-butter-cinnamon, finished under the hearth's top heat. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Strawberry Layer Cake

Three thin egg-raised tortes with chopped strawberries folded into the inner fruit conserve, frosted with rosewater sugar glaze colored with strawberry or cherry juice, crowned with a single strawberry. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Lemon Cake

An egg-raised torte flavored with lemon zest, frosted with saffron-tinted sugar glaze, garnished with candied lemon slices and a halved lemon for presentation. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Strawberry Sweet Cake

A buttered spice torte dusted with finely ground sugar and strewn with fresh or candied strawberries. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Grape Cake

A torte flavored with mosto cotto (reduced must) and raisins, iced with grape-must sugar glaze, decorated with candied violets and elderflowers. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Strawberry Biscuit

Sweet short paste rounds filled with clotted cream or whipped "snowe," layered with macerated strawberries, capped with a thin crisp biscuit and a whole berry. The Aicruaeae equivalent of strawberry shortcake. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Cold Fruit Sponge

A sponge-style torte soaked with sweet cream or almond milk mixed with honey and rosewater, folded with diced peaches, pears, and banana. Best eaten cold. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Capital Fruit Cake

A rich yeast torte heavy with raisins, currants, and candied fruits soaked in hippocras (spiced wine) or aqua vitae. Named for the capital city of Lajazer where it originated as a celebration dish. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Cookie Tower Cake

The most elaborate of all royal cakes, a stunning two-tiered celebration cake served on a wooden board. The base is ringed with embossed sugar cookies standing upright, each stamped with symbolic images: house, flower, crown, sun, moon, tree, deer, bird, and flute. Both tiers are covered in ivory frosting decorated with jam-filled cookies arranged like jeweled medallions. The crown features white chocolate curls piled high with brown chocolate clumps, creating a nest-like effect. Reserved for major festivals and royal celebrations. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Soups

Lentil Soup

Lentils and chickpeas simmered in pottage with onion, leek, herbs, and olive oil, enriched with saffron and verjuice. Served with soft bread. A common dish served to both nobility and commoners during festivals. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Shrimp Soup

"Shrimp-rice-bean soup." Shrimp, short-grain rice, and fava beans in fish stock with saffron, garlic, parsley, and olive oil, finished with verjuice. A coastal specialty that became popular at court after Queen Isalian introduced it. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Desserts & Beverages

Blueberry Cream

Sheep's milk yogurt layered with lightly honeyed bilberries and bilberry syrup made from reduced must and berries. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Iced Banana

A frozen dessert of whipped cream or almond milk sweetened and folded with quince or apple purée, served chilled. One of the earliest frozen treats in Aicruaeen cuisine. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Grape Tart

A grape tart with egg-yolk custard in pastry, studded with raisins and fresh grapes, glazed with reduced must gelled with quince or apple pectin, topped with whole grapes. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Sweetened Grape Pie

A variation of grape pie with rich almond-milk or dairy custard thickened with egg yolks. No glaze, the creamy filling is the focus. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Strawberry Wine

Served two ways: as strawberry-infused hippocras (spiced wine strained over strawberries) or as a straight fruit wine blend. A celebratory drink served at weddings and festivals. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom. A fruit wine produced in Aicruae alongside traditional grape wine. Part of the kingdom's winemaking tradition, sometimes served as a lighter alternative to red wine at celebrations.

Flower Chocolates

Flower-moulded chocolates or marchpane (marzipan) filled with thick fruit pastes in strawberry, lemon, peach, and banana varieties. Often given as gifts during courtship. One of the dishes and desserts developed during the reign of King Hailour Layern Patton II and Queen Isalian Liazen. The royal couple collaborated on recipe creation, and these dishes became cultural touchstones served at festivals, weddings, and court celebrations throughout the kingdom.

Emperor Goteivati's Ten Rules